

Ciara Looney

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Game design is where my creativity and technical background meet. I care deeply about the player experience: what makes a game feel good, what keeps people engaged, what brings a little joy. I'm organised, persistent, and at my best when I'm solving problems that matter.

EDUCATION

Munster Technological University <i>BSc in Software Development</i>	2022-2025
• Final Result: Graduated with Distinction • Sample Results: Modular Prog: 90%; Prog. Fundamentals: 91%; Systems Scripting 86%.	
St. John's College <i>Game design and development</i>	2021-2022
Rochester Institute of Technology (Online) <i>Video game Design and balance</i>	2020
St. Aloysius, Cork <i>Leaving Certificate</i>	2015-2021

WORK EXPERIENCE

Smarttech 24/7 <i>Automation Implementation Graduate</i>	Nov. 2025 – Current
• I assist in the design, development, and deployment of automated workflows using Python and Swimlane SOAR tools. • I collaborate with cybersecurity analysts to understand use cases and translate them into automation playbooks. • I integrate automation tools with existing security tools. • I support testing, troubleshooting, and optimisation of automation scripts and connectors.	
Dell Technologies <i>Software Development Intern</i>	Feb. – Aug. 2025
• I worked with a team in an agile environment. I participated in daily standups and regular reviews where I presented my progress. I also took on a mentoring role for a summer intern. • Developed a program using Python, Flask and JavaScript that uses Llama AI to generate a title, description, and acceptance criteria from user input. Automated the creation and editing of Jira tickets utilizing the Jira API. • Joined the Hackathon Core team. I helped organise the event, and to support the team I developed a program using Python to automate the creation of participant certificates and the process of emailing them.	
Dell Technologies <i>Tech Support.</i>	June – Aug. 2024
• I would help employees set up their new laptop. I reimaged laptops to Linux or Windows if needed. • I ensured zero downtime for 40+ manufacturing PCs by planning replacements ahead of schedule.	
J&K School Books <i>Cashier</i>	July-Sept. 2022
• As a cashier, I would process orders for customers when presented a book list. I was entrusted with handling cash and balancing the till. I would help customers by processing exchanges and refunds.	
Tyler Place Family Resort <i>Receptionist and Cocktail waitress</i>	Aug. – Sept. 2021
• As a receptionist I greeted guests and answered any calls. I also organised babysitters for every family by liaising with staff and ensuring all specific requests were met. • As a cocktail waitress I took drink orders and put them through the POS system, bring them to guests and clear empty glasses. I also assisted in the dining hall.	

Playtester

- Conducted structured playtesting on an unreleased tabletop game prototype for Sky Castle Studios (developers of Hero Forge)
- Provided feedback on mechanics and balance from a player's-eye perspective, contributing to iterative design decisions.

University College Cork

June –Aug. 2020

Software Developer Intern

- I built a scraping program with Golang while also using Linux and GitHub. It would scan for dead links on a website.
- I communicated with a mentor through Slack, I would update them on progress or pitfalls and adapt the project to their ideas.

GAME DESIGN PROJECTS

Smooth Snake for the Nintendo DS

- A stylus-controlled snake game for the Nintendo DS made with C.
- Built and completed my first DS game, gaining hands-on experience in platform-specific design and balancing technical constraints with user experience.

Trivia Game for the Yoto Player

- An interactive audio trivia game for the Yoto Player: a server streams questions to a physical card. The player gets instant feedback on their choices and a final score reveal.
- Built with FastAPI and MQTT to detect live player input in real time, with randomised question sets giving each playthrough replay value.

Choose Your Own Adventure Game for the Yoto Player

- A branching audio adventure for the Yoto Player: insert the card, listen to the story, and press buttons to make choices, landing on a different ending depending on your decisions.
- Designed the branching narrative structure to give players meaningful choices through an audio-only interface

Pocket Pet Mobile App**Grade: 83%**

- A Tamagotchi-style virtual pet app for mobile, designed around an emotional core loop that keeps players engaged and invested in their pet's wellbeing. Built in Kotlin with Room database for persistent pet tracking.

SOFTWARE PROJECTS

Agile Group Project**Grade: 89%**

- An interactive booking website and matching app built with JavaScript, CSS and Node.js using MongoDB for database management
- Took on group leader role, assigned tasks via Trello, organised meetings, liaised updates with lecturer.

AI Investment Group Project

- A website built with Node.js, MongoDB, HTML, and JavaScript, utilizing an Agentic AI for investment advice.
- A matching app built with Kotlin, using Firebase and Firestore for database and authentication.
- I built full authentication (login, signup, password reset) for the website and the app. I also did Google Pay integration on the app and the website's CSS.

VOLUNTEERING

VEX Robotics Competition**2025**

- Over 2 days I served as a referee and judge for the robotics competition, ensuring fair play and evaluating teams.

Irish Guide Dogs**2018**

- Cleaned the puppy kennels daily, Fed and walked puppies, 8-hour shifts, 5x per week. TY Work Experience.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Technologies** Python; Kotlin; Java; JavaScript; Node.js; MongoDB; SQL; Visual Paradigm; Unity; Web Dev.
- **Interests:** Traveling; Robotics; Animals; Art; Video games; Participated in Dell Hackathon.